

FILM DOSSIER: BLACK PANTHER

Phase 3 · Film #2 (Saga Film #19)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	19 of 29 (Phase 3, Film #2)
Phase	Phase 3
Real title	BLACK PANTHER
Decoy / codename title	"MOTHERLAND"
Release date	Friday, July 8, 2016
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Director	Ryan Coogler
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 158 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + royal succession drama / Afrofuturist epic

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	CHADWICK BOSEMAN. The Black Panther franchise is his.

Character	Actor	Age at release
T'Challa / Black Panther	Chadwick Boseman	39
N'Jadaka / Erik Killmonger	Michael B. Jordan	29
Nakia (<i>of the Dora Milaje</i>)	Lupita Nyong'o	33
Okoye (<i>of the Dora Milaje</i>)	Danai Gurira	38
Shuri	Letitia Wright	22
Queen Mother Ramonda	Angela Bassett	57
Zuri	Forest Whitaker	54
W'Kabi	Daniel Kaluuya	27
M'Baku / Man-Ape	Winston Duke	29
Ulysses Klaw	Andy Serkis	52
King T'Chaka (<i>flashbacks</i>)	John Kani	72
Reed Richards (<i>cameo</i>)	Pedro Pascal	41
Stan Lee (<i>cameo: a man at a casino bar in Busan</i>)	Stan Lee	93

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	<i>"Panther's Rage"</i> , <i>Jungle Action</i> #6–18 (1973–75), Don McGregor & Billy Graham: Erik Killmonger leads a rebellion in Wakanda, throws T'Challa over Warrior Falls , and T'Challa comes back to fight for his throne. <i>Fantastic Four</i> #52–53 (1966), Stan Lee & Jack Kirby: T'Challa's debut, Klaw murdering King T'Chaka , Wakanda, vibranium.
Supporting comics	<i>Avengers</i> #62 (1969, M'Baku / Man-Ape) · <i>Black Panther</i> vol. 3 (1998–2003, Christopher Priest: the Dora Milaje, Okoye and Nakia) · <i>Black Panther</i> vol. 4 #2 (2005, Shuri) · <i>Jungle Action</i> #6 (1973, W'Kabi and Zuri)
Nerf check	✅ Killmonger beats T'Challa and throws him over Warrior Falls , exactly as in <i>Jungle Action</i> #6. T'Challa wins the rematch through will , not a sudden power-up.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	96% . "Panther's Rage" is adapted with its structure intact, and <i>FF</i> #52–53 supplies the backstory.

Straight from the page:

- **Wakanda**: an isolated, hyper-advanced African nation built on the world's only **vibranium** mound (*FF* #52).
- **Klaw murdered King T'Chaka** when T'Challa was a boy. **Young T'Challa destroyed Klaw's right hand** (*FF* #53).
- **The Heart-Shaped Herb** gives the Black Panther his powers, and **the Panther God Bast** chooses the king (616).
- **Erik Killmonger, born N'Jadaka in Wakanda**, was exiled when Klaw took his family. He grew up in the U.S. and came back **to take the throne** (*Jungle Action* #6).
- **Killmonger throws T'Challa over Warrior Falls** (*Jungle Action* #6). **T'Challa survives, and returns** (#6–18).
- **W'Kabi**, T'Challa's security chief, **wavers in his loyalty** (*Jungle Action*).
- **The Dora Milaje**, the king's elite guard (Priest).
- **M'Baku** challenges T'Challa for the throne, and **becomes Man-Ape** (*Avengers* #62).
- **Shuri**, T'Challa's brilliant sister (vol. 4).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| Nakia's 616 turn to villainy (as Malice) is held back | It's held for a sequel. She's loyal in this film. |

| Klaw's appearance is a cameo | He was the villain in *Ultron Unlimited*'s mid-credit scene, and this finishes his story |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Black Panther	The Heart-Shaped Herb: peak-human-plus strength, speed, agility, stamina and senses; genius scientist and strategist ; master of every fighting style ; vibranium habit (a suit that absorbs kinetic energy); king of the richest nation on Earth (<i>FF</i> #52)	All of it: outruns a speeding car on foot, climbs a sheer cliff, beats M'Baku in ritual combat, out-strategizes Killmonger in the final battle	His Avengers-level leadership (on 616 he's an Avenger from #52)	✓ 100%
Killmonger	Peak-human genius ; expert tactician, martial artist and marksman; later empowered by the Heart-Shaped Herb (<i>Jungle Action</i> #6)	Takes the herb and matches T'Challa physically	–	✓ 100%
Shuri	Genius scientist and inventor	Builds Wakanda's technology and T'Challa's new suit	Her own Panther mantle (616 later)	✓ 100%
The Dora Milaje	Elite warriors	Okoye's spear work	–	✓ 100%
M'Baku	Great strength; the White Gorilla cult	Ritual combat	–	✓ 100%
Klaw	A sonic weapon grafted to his wrist	A casino fight in Busan	–	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	The new king of the most advanced nation on Earth comes home to take his father's throne, and finds that a Wakandan exile with a claim of his own has come home first.
Theme	What does a king owe the world? Wakanda has hidden itself for centuries. Killmonger asks whether it had the right to.
Villain / antagonist	N'Jadaka / Erik Killmonger (main); Klaw ; M'Baku (a rival who becomes an ally)

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: THE KING

- **Wakanda, Monday, April 25, 2016.** Two weeks after Civil War, **T'Challa** comes home to be crowned.

- **M'Baku** of the Jabari challenges him at Warrior Falls. T'Challa wins, and **saves him**.
- **Klaw** surfaces in **Busan**, selling stolen vibranium. T'Challa, **Nakia** and **Okoye** go after him in a casino and on a car chase through the city.
- Klaw's buyer shoots him and takes the vibranium. The buyer is **Erik Killmonger**.

ACT TWO: WARRIOR FALLS

- Killmonger arrives in Wakanda with **Klaw's body** as proof. **He's Wakandan**: born **N'Jadaka**, exiled as a child, and the son of a Wakandan the royal family abandoned.
- He demands **ritual combat for the throne**.
- **At Warrior Falls, Killmonger beats T'Challa and throws him over the falls**.
- **Killmonger becomes king**, takes the **Heart-Shaped Herb**, and orders that **Wakandan weapons be shipped to the world's oppressed**.
- **W'Kabi** backs him. Okoye stays loyal to the throne, whoever sits on it.

ACT THREE: PANTHER'S RAGE

- **M'Baku** has T'Challa's broken body, which the Jabari pulled out of the river.
- **Bast** speaks to T'Challa in the ancestral plane, and **his father** asks him: *"What will you do differently?"*
- T'Challa comes back. **Shuri** gives him a new suit.
- **The battle for Wakanda**: the Jabari, the Dora Milaje and **the whole nation divided**.
- **T'Challa vs. Killmonger** in the vibranium mines. **T'Challa wins**.
- Killmonger, dying, refuses to be healed: *"Bury me in the ocean with my ancestors who jumped from the ships."*
- **T'Challa takes Wakanda into the world**: an outreach center in Oakland, and a seat at the United Nations: *"Wakanda will no longer watch from the shadows."*

5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, April 25, 2016 → Saturday, June 18, 2016.
Where it's set	Wakanda (Birnin Zana, Warrior Falls, the Jabari mountains, the vibranium mines) · Busan, South Korea · Oakland, California (filmed on location in South Africa, Uganda, Zambia's Victoria Falls, South Korea and Oakland)
Relative to other films	Two weeks after <i>Civil War</i> . T'Challa's side in that conflict is part of the political pressure on him at home.

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **Wakanda:** its tribes, its traditions, vibranium, the Heart-Shaped Herb, Bast, the ancestral plane.
- **The Dora Milaje, Shuri, M'Baku, W'Kabi, Ramonda.**
- **Wakanda goes public**, which changes the MCU's geopolitics.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
Wakanda is open	The UN speech	<i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i>
The Fantastic Four	Reed Richards, who fought T'Challa years ago (616: <i>FF</i> #52), congratulates him on the crowning: " <i>No hard feelings about the jungle trap?</i> "	Future FF films
Vibranium on the market	Killmonger's shipments are only partly recovered	Phase 3

Setting up the Big Bad

Seed	How it appears	What it means
Bast's warning	In the ancestral plane, Bast shows T'Challa a vision: half the stars in the sky going out at once. " <i>The Titan's gift. Be ready, my son.</i> "	The snap is coming , and Wakanda will be needed

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	✅ " THE UNITED NATIONS. " T'Challa finishes his speech. A delegate scoffs: " <i>What can a nation of farmers offer the world?</i> " T'Challa and Okoye look at each other and smile.
Post-credit scene	✅ " THE SURFER. " A rooftop in New York at night. The Silver Surfer , trapped on Earth, feels something in the cosmos shift . He clutches his head and cries out: " <i>The Gauntlet... he's going to use it.</i> " On the next roof over, Doctor Stephen Strange watches him, with his cloak moving in the windless air. CUT TO BLACK. " BLACK PANTHER WILL RETURN. "
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: " GENERAL ASSEMBLY. " Post-credit: " ROOFTOP. "

CHECKLIST

- ☒ Comic(s) adapted · ☒ Comic Accuracy Report + powers · ☒ Real and decoy titles · ☒ What it's about · ☒ Villain · ☒ Post-credit scenes · ☒ The film's own world-building · ☒ MCU world-building · ☒ Big Bad setup · ☒ Whose franchise · ☒ When and where in the timeline